January 28, 2026

BRITISH DAREL WILLIAMS
7975 NEMOURS PKWY
ORLANDO FL 32827

We made a decision on your VA benefits.

Dear British Williams:

This letter will guide you through the information you should know and steps you may take now that VA has made a decision about your benefits.

Your Benefit Information:

- Service connection for erectile dysfunction is denied.
- The claim for an increased evaluation for residuals of right knee arthroscopy (claimed as arthritis, lower extremities, bilateral) is deferred.

As a Veteran with a service-connected disability, you may be eligible for up to $40,000 in VA life insurance benefits. Veterans Affairs Life Insurance (VALife) is guaranteed acceptance whole life insurance available to all service-connected, disabled veterans with no time limit to apply as long as you are age 80 or under. Veterans age 81 and over are still eligible in certain circumstances. Visit the VALife Insurance website, https://www.va.gov/life-insurance/options-eligibility/valife/, for further information.

Your combined evaluation for all of your service-connected disabilities and your VA compensation payment will continue unchanged. There are no retroactive payments. The rates below are for informational and historical purposes only.

Your monthly entitlement amount is shown below:

Monthly Entitlement Amount	Payment Start Date	Reason
$698.47	Dec 1, 2025	Cost of Living Adjustment

We have included with this letter:

1. Explanation of Payment
2. Additional Benefits
3. Where to Send Your Correspondence
4. VA Form 20-0998
5. Rating Decision
6. Fraud Prevention Attachment

Contact information:

Web: www.va.gov
Phone: 1-800-827-1000
TDD: 711
To send questions online: visit https://ask.va.gov/

Social Media:

Twitter: @VAVetBenefits
Facebook: www.facebook.com/VeteransBenefits

How to obtain representation:

We have no record of you appointing an accredited representative. Accredited representatives are trained to help you understand and apply for VA benefits. For more information about how an accredited representative can help you, please visit: https://www.vets.gov/disability-benefits/apply-for-benefits/help/

If you or someone you know is in crisis, call the *Veterans Crisis Line* by dialing 988 and then pressing 1.

Monthly Entitlement Amount	Payment Start Date	Reason
$666.47	Jun 18, 2030	Minor Child Adjustment
$617.47	May 29, 2031	Minor Child Adjustment

We are currently paying you as a Veteran with 3 dependents. *Let us know right away if there is any change in the status of your dependents.*

If payments are due, you should receive your first payment, if not already in receipt of payments, within 7-10 days of this notice.

See **Explanation of Payment** for more details about your payment.

Your payment will be directed to the financial institution and account number that you specified. To confirm when your payment was deposited, please contact your financial institution.

If this account is no longer open,

please notify us immediately.

What You Should Do If You Disagree With Our Decision

If you do not agree with our decision, you have one year from the date of this letter to select a review option to protect your initial filing date for effective date purposes. You must file your request on the required application form for the review option desired. The table below represents the review options and their respective required application form.

Review Option	Required Application Form
Supplemental Claim	VA Form 20-0995, *Decision Review Request: Supplemental Claim*
Higher-Level Review	VA Form 20-0996, *Decision Review Request: Higher-Level Review*
Appeal to the Board of Veterans' Appeals	VA Form 10182, *Decision Review Request: Board Appeal (Notice of Disagreement)*

Please note: You **may not** request a higher-level review of a higher-level review decision issued by VA.

The enclosed VA Form 20-0998, *Your Right To Seek Review Of Our Decision*, explains your options in greater detail and provides instructions on how to request further review. You may download a copy of any of the required application forms noted above by visiting www.va.gov/vaforms/ or you may contact us by telephone at 1-800-827-1000 and we will mail you any form you need.

You can visit www.va.gov/decision-reviews to learn more about how the disagreement process works.

Important: If you have a service-connected condition which you feel has worsened and is no longer accurately reflected by the level of disability assigned, please use VA Form 21-526EZ, *Application for Disability Compensation and Related Compensation Benefits* to request an increased evaluation. However, if you disagree with a decision made within the last year, please refer to the enclosed VA Form 20-0998, *Your Right To Seek Review Of Our Decision*. If you would like us to review a claim that was denied more than one year ago, and you have new and relevant evidence for us to consider, please use VA Form 20-0995, *Decision Review Request: Supplemental Claim*.

If you would like to obtain or access evidence used in making this decision, please contact us by telephone, email, or letter as noted below letting us know what you would like to obtain. Some evidence may be obtained online by visiting www.va.gov.

You may also use the following link to access your Public Contact representative at your local VA Regional Office for assistance at https://va.my.site.com/VAVERA/s/.

Thank you for your service,

Regional Office Director

Explanation of Payment

Your monthly entitlement amount includes payment for the following dependent(s):

Payment Start Date	Award Dependent(s)
Dec 1, 2025	Broderick, Brick, Kellie
Jun 18, 2030	Broderick, Kellie
May 29, 2031	Kellie

Let us know right away if there is any change in the status of your dependent(s).

Please Take Action: What Things Affect Your Right to Payment?

Please notify VA ***immediately*** if there is a change in any condition affecting your right to continued payments. If you don't notify us of these changes immediately, you may have to return any overpayments. Those changes include:

Evidence received shows a change is warranted.
Military Pay or Worker's Compensation: Your payments may be affected by the following, which you must bring to our attention: • Reentrance into active military or naval service. • Receipt of armed forces service retirement pay, unless your retirement pay has already been reduced because of award of disability compensation. • Receipt of benefits from the Office of Federal Employees Compensation. • Receipt of active duty or drill pay as a reservist or member of the National Guard.
Dependents: If you have a disability rating of 30 percent or more, you must advise VA of any change with your spouse or children.
Hospitalization: If your award includes Aid and Attendance benefits, we may reduce this additional allowance if you are admitted to a hospital, nursing home, or domiciliary care at VA expense.
Incarceration: Benefits will be reduced if you are incarcerated in a federal, state, or local penal institution for more than 60 days for conviction of a felony.
Lack of Cooperation: We may stop monthly payments if you: • fail to submit evidence we requested, • fail to attend a VA examination when requested, or • Submit false or fraudulent evidence to VA, or cause false or fraudulent evidence to be submitted to VA.

Evidence received shows a change is warranted.
Fraud/Lying to Government: The law provides severe penalties, which include fines, imprisonment, or both, for the fraudulent acceptance of any payment to which you are not entitled. We may verify information you submit through computer-matching programs with other agencies.

Additional Benefits

Medical Care and Treatment:

- Mental Health Counseling: For more information, please visit www.myhealth.va.gov/mhv-portal-web/.
- Blind Rehabilitation: For more information, please visit www.va.gov/blindrehab/.

Home Adaptations/Loans, Automobile Benefits, and Life Insurance:

- Loans: For more information, please visit www.benefits.va.gov/homeloans/.
- Funding Fee Refund: If you paid a funding fee at the closing of a VA guaranteed home loan and your VA compensation award provides an effective rating date that was prior to your loan closing date, then you may be eligible for a funding fee refund. Please contact either your current mortgage servicer or a VA Regional Loan Center at (877) 827-3702 to begin the refund process.
- Government life insurance: As a Veteran with a service-connected disability, you may be eligible for up to $40,000 in VA life insurance benefits. Veterans Affairs Life Insurance (VALife) is guaranteed acceptance whole life insurance available to all service-connected, disabled veterans with no time limit to apply as long as you are age 80 or under. Veterans age 81 and over are still eligible in certain circumstances. For more information on VALife, please visit https://www.va.gov/life-insurance/options-eligibility/valife/.

Armed Forces Commissary and Exchange:

- You may be entitled to Armed Forces Commissary and Exchange privileges. Honorably discharged Veterans with a service-connected disability; Former Prisoners of War; Purple Heart or Medal of Honor recipients; military retirees; members of the reserves; and their dependents may qualify for entitlement to this additional benefit. For more information, please visit va.gov/resources/commissary-and-exchange-privileges-for-veterans.

Where to Send Your Correspondence
Documents may be submitted by mail, in person at a VA regional office or electronically. However, VA recommends submitting correspondence electronically as this is the fastest method of receipt. VA provides several tools to assist in electronic submission. To learn more about how to submit documents and claims electronically, visit **www.va.gov/disability/upload-supporting-evidence**. You can also go directly to AccessVA (**https://eauth.va.gov/accessva/?cspselectfor=quicksubmit**) to digitally upload any correspondence using QuickSubmit. By visiting **www.va.gov** you can also check your claim status and learn about other VA benefits. If you need assistance, you can find a local, accredited representative at **https://www.benefits.va.gov/vso/**.

If you prefer to mail your correspondence, please use the related mailing address below:

Compensation Benefits	Pension & Survivors Benefits
Department of Veterans Affairs Compensation Intake Center P.O. Box 4444 Janesville, WI 53547 Toll Free Phone: 1-800-827-1000 Toll Free Fax: (844) 531-7818	Department of Veterans Affairs Pension Intake Center P.O. Box 5365 Janesville, WI 53547 Toll Free Phone: 1-800-827-1000 Toll Free Fax: (844) 655-1604
Board of Veterans' Appeals	**Fiduciary**
Department of Veterans Affairs Board of Veterans' Appeals P.O. Box 27063 Washington, DC 20038 Toll Free Fax. (844) 678-8979	Department of Veterans Affairs Fiduciary Intake Center P.O. Box 5211 Janesville, WI 53547 Toll Free Phone: 1-800-827-1000 Toll Free Fax: (888) 581-6826

These addresses serve **all United States and foreign locations**.

Veterans Crisis Line DIAL 988 then PRESS 1	**Veteran Crisis Line Dial 988 then Press 1** You can also send a text message to 838255 to receive confidential support 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, 365 days a year. For more information, visit **www.veteranscrisisline.net**

WTSYC (November 2022)

U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs

YOUR RIGHT TO SEEK REVIEW OF OUR DECISION

This document outlines your right to seek review of our decision on any issue with which you disagree. You may generally select one of three different review options for each issue decided by VA. However, you may not request review of the same issue using more than one option at the same time. Below is information on the three different review options.

	Supplemental Claim	Higher-Level Review	Board Appeal
What Is This?	A reviewer will determine whether new and relevant evidence changes the prior decision.	An experienced claims adjudicator will review your decision using the same evidence VA considered in the prior decision.	A Veterans Law Judge at the Board of Veterans' Appeals (Board) will review your decision.
By Selecting This Option	You are adding or identifying new and relevant evidence to support your claim that we did not previously consider. VA will assist you in gathering new and relevant evidence that you identify to support your claim. You are entitled to a hearing at any time in the supplemental claim process.	You have no additional evidence to submit to support your claim, but you believe there was an error in the prior decision. You can request an optional, one-time, informal conference with a Higher-Level Reviewer to identify specific errors in the case, although requesting this conference may delay the review.	You must choose a docket: **Direct Review** - You do not want to submit evidence or have a hearing. **Evidence Submission** - You choose to submit additional evidence without a hearing. **Hearing** - You choose to have a hearing with a Veterans Law Judge.
Goal To Complete	**125 days** on average	**125 days** on average	**365 days** on average for Direct Review (longer for the other options)
Form To File*	VA Form 20-0995 *Decision Review Request: Supplemental Claim*	VA Form 20-0996 *Decision Review Request: Higher-Level Review*	VA Form 10182 *Decision Review Request: Board Appeal (Notice of Disagreement)*
Scan QR Code to Access Form			
Further Options After This Decision Review	You may request another Supplemental Claim, a Higher-Level Review, or a Board Appeal.	You may request a Supplemental Claim or a Board Appeal.	You may request a Supplemental Claim or appeal to the U.S. Court of Appeals for Veterans Claims.

For most VA benefits, **you have 1 year from the date on your decision notice to request a decision review to ensure the earliest possible effective date.** Consult your decision notice for specific limitations.

* All forms listed are available at www.va.gov/find-forms/ or use your mobile device camera to scan the QR code to take you directly to the form you select.

If you do not submit a decision review request within the required time, you may only seek review through the following:

- A request to revise the decision based on a clear and unmistakable error, or
- A Supplemental Claim. If you file a Supplemental Claim after the **1-year** time limit, the effective date for any resulting award of benefits generally will be tied to the date VA receives the Supplemental Claim.
  - If you wish to have a hearing during the supplemental claim process, you can contact us online through Ask VA: https://ask.va.gov/ or call us toll-free at 1-800-827-1000 (TTY:711).

While most decision review options are available to you, there are limitations based on the type of decision you received.

- If you are a party to a **contested claim** - such as claims for apportionment, attorney fee disagreement, or multiple parties filing for survivor's benefits or claims for life insurance - your *only* option for disagreeing with your decision is to file a Board Appeal within **60 days** of the date on your decision notice.
- If you are seeking review of an **insurance decision** you have an *additional* option to challenge VA's decision by filing a complaint with a United States district court in the jurisdiction in which you reside within 6 years from when the right of action first accrues. Consult your decision notice for details on what options are available and where to send the request.

Get Help with Your Review Request:

For more information on all the available review options, contact us at 1-800-827-1000 or visit www.va.gov/decision-reviews/. If you need help filing a decision review, you may want to work with an accredited attorney, claims agent, or a Veterans Service Organization (VSO) representative. Additional information about working with an accredited attorney, claims agent, or VSO representative is available at www.va.gov/decision-reviews/get-help-with-review-request/. You can find a searchable database of VA-recognized representatives at www.va.gov/ogc/apps/accreditation.

Scan the QR Code to Open the Appropriate Decision Review Website Page

Supplemental Claim	Higher-Level Review	Board Appeal

DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS
Veterans Benefits Administration
Regional Office

BRITISH WILLIAMS

VA File Number
266 67 7376

Rating Decision
01/27/2026

INTRODUCTION

The records reflect that you are a Veteran of the Peacetime. You served in the Army from October 28, 1986 to October 27, 1988. You filed a new claim for benefits that was received on December 17, 2025. Based on a review of the evidence listed below, we have made the following decision(s) on your claim.

DECISION

1. Service connection for erectile dysfunction is denied.

2. The claim for an increased evaluation for residuals of right knee arthroscopy (claimed as arthritis, lower extremities, bilateral) is deferred.

EVIDENCE

- DD Form 214, Certificate of Release or Discharge from Active Duty, for the period October 28, 1986 to October 27, 1988, received February 6, 2024
- Service Treatment and Personnel Records, for the period October 28, 1986 to October 27, 1988
- VA Form 21-526EZ, Application for Disability Compensation and Related Compensation

Benefits, received December 17, 2025
- VA Form 21-4138 Statement in Support of Claim received December 17, 2025
- Veteran Lay Statement, received December 17, 2025
- Toxic Exposure Risk Activity (TERA) memo dated January 13, 2026
- Disability Benefits Questionnaires, Niyati Vyarawala, NP, conducted on January 21, 2026

REASONS FOR DECISION

1. Service connection for erectile dysfunction.

Service connection for erectile dysfunction is denied.

A direct grant of service connection requires: 1) medical evidence of a current disability, 2) evidence of the incurrence or aggravation of a disease or injury in active military service, and 3) medical evidence of a nexus (link) between the current disability and the in-service disease or injury. (38 CFR 3.303, 38 CFR 3.304)

Service connection may be granted for a disease or injury which resulted from a service-connected disability or was aggravated thereby. (38 CFR 3.303, 38 CFR 3.304, 38 CFR 3.310)

The evidence does not show a current diagnosed disability. (38 CFR 3.159, 38 CFR 3.303) The evidence does not show an event, disease or injury in service. (38 CFR 3.303, 38 CFR 3.304) Your service treatment records do not contain complaints, treatment, or diagnosis for this condition. We did not find a link between your medical condition and military service. (38 CFR 3.303)

Service connection may be granted for a condition diagnosed after military discharge provided evidence establishes that the condition was caused by service. Service connection may be granted on this basis for a disability related to toxic exposure risk activity (TERA) during military service if evidence demonstrates that the Veteran was actually exposed in service and that a disease associated with such exposure resulted. (38 CFR 3.303, 38 CFR 3.304)

We considered whether your condition resulted from a toxic exposure risk activity (TERA) in service; however, the evidence does not show that you participated in a TERA. (38 U.S.C. 1168, 38 U.S.C. 1710(e)(4)

There is no basis in the available evidence of record to establish service connection for erectile dysfunction. This condition did not happen in military service, nor was it aggravated or caused by service. (38 CFR 3.303, 38 CFR 3.304, 38 CFR 3.306)

It has not been established that erectile dysfunction resulted from TERA participation in this case because the evidence does not show a diagnosis of erectile dysfunction. (38 CFR 3.303, 38 CFR 3.304)

Favorable Findings identified in this decision:

The claimed primary disability, residuals of right knee arthroscopy, is service-connected.

2. Evaluation of residuals of right knee arthroscopy (claimed as arthritis, lower extremities, bilateral) currently evaluated as 10 percent disabling.

The evaluation for residuals of right knee arthroscopy (claimed as arthritis, lower extremities, bilateral) is deferred for the following: VA examination clarification

REFERENCES:

Title 38 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Pensions, Bonuses and Veterans' Relief contains the regulations of the Department of Veterans Affairs which govern entitlement to all Veteran benefits. For additional information regarding applicable laws and regulations, please consult your local library, or visit us at our website, www.va.gov.

Fraud Prevention: Protect Your Benefits

Please contact the VA ***immediately*** at 1-800-827-1000 if you suspect your information is compromised.

- You receive correspondence from VA concerning a claim, and you don't remember filing a claim contact the VA at 1-800-827-1000.
- You receive correspondence requesting a processing fee prior to releasing benefit payments contact the VA at 1-800-827-1000.
- VA may check in with you by phone, email, or text message. The VA will **never ask for personal information via email.** This includes verification of your SSN, address, and/or bank information. If you are unsure about any call, email, or text, confirm details directly with the VA.
- VA **does not threaten** claimants with jail or lawsuits.
- Be cautions of telephone numbers on caller ID. Scammers may change the telephone number (spoofing) to make a call appear to come from a different person or place.
- When in doubt, hang up and call VA directly at 1-800-827-1000, or call your Power of Attorney representative (DAV, VFW, etc.).
- **Do not ignore emails or letters** from the VA notifying you of an update to direct deposit or eBenefits account information. If you don't remember making changes, it could be the first sign your information was compromised.
- Use secure, unique passwords, and two factor identification where available. To establish a more secure logon for Vets.gov and ebenefits.va.gov with two factor identification create an account via ID.me at https://api.id.me/en/registration/new
- Monitor your accounts regularly, respond to fraud alerts and report unauthorized transactions promptly.
- To learn more about protecting yourself from fraud, and how to report it visit https://www.va.gov/oig/hotline/default.asp, or go to VA.gov and search "Office of Inspector General".
- For more details on how to avoid scams go to https://www.fcc.gov/veterans-targeted-benefits-scams
- Download free financial scam awareness resources at https://www.consumerfinance.gov/about-us/blog/helping-prevent-scams-targeted-veterans/
- Get up-to-date information on fraud and scams from the Federal Trade Commission https://public.tableau.com/profile/federal.trade.commission